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Серия «Денежный поток» № 2: составление прогноза движения денежных средств на 18 месяцев



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Мы с гордостью представляем вам эту образовательную серию из трех частей, посвященную прогнозированию денежных потоков. В этой серии мы шаг за шагом расскажем, как составить собственный 18-месячный бизнес-прогноз, и предоставим вам ключевые инструменты и информацию, которые вы сможете использовать в своем финансовом планировании.



Если вы запутались в процессе, воспользуйтесь этими ссылками, чтобы вернуться на правильный путь:

[Часть 1. Постановка целей и заполнение вкладки «Подготовительный лист»](#)

Часть 2. Создание модели прогнозирования денежных потоков (вы здесь)

[Часть 3. Использование модели для составления прогнозов](#)

Добро пожаловать в нашу серию статей о прогнозировании денежных потоков с помощью Jirav! В нашей [первой статье](#) мы рассказали о трех шагах, которые необходимо предпринять, прежде чем приступить к прогнозированию денежных потоков. Денежные потоки показывают, какой ликвидностью или денежными средствами располагает ваша компания для покрытия краткосрочных обязательств, и эта информация должна быть включена в [бизнес-план](#). Анализ текущих показателей вашей компании с помощью [отчета о движении денежных средств](#) и прогнозирование будущих денежных потоков дают вам важное представление о вашей компании и помогут избежать дефицита денежных средств.

Поскольку прогнозирование как часть управления денежными потоками крайне важно для вас как владельца малого бизнеса или начинающего предпринимателя, чтобы построить реалистичную финансовую модель и сохранить бизнес, начните с загрузки шаблона финансовой бизнес-модели и заполнения вкладки «Подготовительный лист». Подготовительный лист соответствует [шагу 3](#) из первой статьи серии. Введенная вами информация станет основой вашего прогноза.



Шаблон прогнозирования денежных потоков для малого бизнеса

[Создайте свою копию бесплатного шаблона прогнозирования денежных потоков здесь.](#)

Вы также можете посмотреть наше видео с пошаговым руководством по созданию и использованию модели:

Теперь перейдем к прогнозированию.

Прорабатываем различные сценарии

Прогнозирование денежных потоков — это процесс, ориентированный на будущее, поскольку вы прогнозируете то, что, по вашему мнению, а в некоторых случаях и в надежде, произойдет. Некоторые цифры, которые вы используете, основаны на том, что уже происходило в вашем бизнесе, например ежемесячные платежи по обязательствам и постоянные расходы.

Такие показатели, как количество новых клиентов, которых вы будете привлекать каждый месяц, по-прежнему основаны на фактической информации (например, о драйверах, которые вы определили в [первой части нашей серии статей](#)), но они не являются гарантированными. Эти показатели вы будете корректировать по мере создания финансовой модели.

Before you start forecasting, consider two to three scenarios you want to run in a cash flow forecast. Some examples are:

Operating your business at 50–75% capacity

- Meeting your break-even point
- Increasing revenue by 20% every month

- Hiring three new employees this year

Your business's current challenges or goals, which you set in [Step 1](#) of our prep article, will help you identify which scenarios to run.

Pro tip: After you fill out the Prep Sheet tab, make several copies of the template so you can run different scenarios. To make a copy in Google Sheets, go to File → Make a copy. Pull up one of your copies as you read through this article so you can follow along. Let's dive in!

Step 1: Revenue & COGS

The first step is to project your revenue for each product and service that you sell using the Revenue tab of the template.

Each product or service that you listed on the prep sheet will auto-populate the Revenue & COGS tab. Month 1 is based on the current sales figures you entered on the prep sheet. Your job is to adjust the quantity and price of each product or service for the following months, based on your projections. (Tip: Press the + button to adjust the price and quantity for each product or service.)

Product	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3	Month 4	Month 5	Month 6	Month 7	Month 8	Month 9	Month 10	Month 11
Revenue	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000
COGS	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500
Profit	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500

Uhhhhhhh ... but how do I project how much I'm going to make?

Begin by using your most recent month of financial data as a starting point. From there, consider the revenue drivers for each product or service listed. How will those drivers impact your revenue in the next six months? And how will your specific goals change those drivers?

Let's say you're a digital marketing agency and one of your revenue streams is new client projects. The average revenue from a new project is \$1,000.

You acquire new clients through website visitors. Currently, you receive 5,000 new visitors per month, and your conversion rate is 0.5%. Based on these numbers, every month, you receive 25 new clients, which is \$25,000 in revenue.

But what happens if your goal is to increase new website visitors by 1,000 each month?

Now your forecast would look like this:

Month 1: $6,000 \times 0.5\% = 30$; $30 \times \$1,000 = \$30,000$

Month 2: $7,000 \times 0.5\% = 35$; $35 \times \$1,000 = \$35,000$

Month 3: $8,000 \times 0.5\% = 40$; $40 \times \$1,000 = \$40,000$

Also, consider what external factors could impact your revenue drivers. For example, say you're a restaurant and one of your revenue streams is dine-in customers. A driver is the number of daily dine-in customers. Government-mandated COVID-19 shutdowns that ban indoor dining will impact that driver.

Finally, keep in mind how drivers for different revenue streams can impact each other. Let's go back to our restaurant that's closed to dine-in customers. While that revenue stream may have plummeted to \$0, some of those diners converted to take-out diners, which increased take-out revenue.

Let's lay out some assumptions to see the interplay:

Average daily dine-in customers: 60 (1,800 customers per month)

Average dine-in order value per customer: \$40 (\$72,000 revenue per month)

Number of dine-in customers converted to take-out diners: 20% (an increase of \$14,400 in take-out revenue per month)

Knowing these numbers, we can now set a goal to increase the conversion of existing dine-in customers to take-out customers to recover revenue. Let's set the goal to increase the conversion of dine-in customers to take out customers by 5% every month.

Here's how that would look:

Month 1: $1,800 \times 0.25 = 450$; $450 \times \$40 = \$18,000$

Month 2: $1,800 \times 0.30 = 540$; $540 \times \$40 = \$21,600$

Month 3: $1,800 \times 0.35 = 630$; $630 \times \$40 = \$25,200$

Pro tip: We know that keeping track of all these drivers is a lot. If you have complex and interrelated revenue drivers or want to create a more in-depth forecast, we recommend using [Jirav's budgeting and forecasting accounting software](#). Jirav connects to your accounting system and Gusto to import your historical financial and workforce data so that you can start planning right away.*

Step 2: Cost of Goods Sold

Under the revenue forecast is your COGS forecast. Like the revenue section, the COGS section is auto-populated by the information you entered in the Prep Sheet tab, and Month 1 reflects your current monthly sales that are cash inflows.

For each month, project the quantity of each product that you'll purchase and the cost of it during that period of time.



The screenshot shows a spreadsheet with a dark green header bar. Below the header, there are several rows of data. The first row is highlighted in red. The columns represent months from January to December. The rows represent different product categories or items. The data cells contain numerical values, likely representing costs or quantities.

Wait—why would the cost of my product change on a monthly basis?

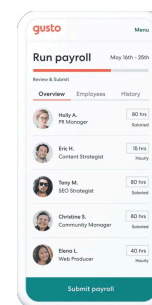
As your business grows, you may find ways to decrease your product or service costs and increase your overall margins. This could even be one of your goals.

You may change vendors, switch to using less expensive materials, or invest in machinery that reduces your labor costs. All of these changes would decrease the cost of your products or services.



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Step 3: Workforce

For many businesses, staffing has a significant impact on their overall cash flow, profitability, and ability to earn revenue. With more staff, a business's capacity to sell its product or service (and earn revenue) increases. But payroll costs can add up, and many businesses wonder if they can [afford the cost of new hires](#).

When is the right time to hire someone? And how can you be sure you can afford your new hire? What about laying people off? At what point do you need to consider reducing your workforce? Forecasting your staffing needs answers these questions.

It's time to plan for staffing changes using the Workforce tab. In the Prep Sheet, you already added your existing staff, which will auto-populate the first 10 lines of the Workforce tab.

New employees can be added on the extra lines, and by completing the new employee's start month and monthly base salary. The forecast will calculate your total staffing costs based on the employee's first month of hire.

You can also adjust the salary percentage of the benefits for each month if you find a lower-cost way to administer your benefits or decide to increase your benefits package.

The screenshot shows a spreadsheet with a table of employee benefits. The table has columns for 'Employee', 'Benefit', 'Rate', and 12 months of data. The 'Employee' column lists 'John Smith', 'Jane Smith', 'John Smith', 'Jane Smith', 'John Smith', 'Jane Smith', 'John Smith', 'Jane Smith', 'John Smith', 'Jane Smith', 'John Smith', 'Jane Smith'. The 'Benefit' column lists 'Health Insurance', 'Dental Insurance', 'Life Insurance', 'Disability Insurance', 'Retirement', 'Medical Insurance', 'Vision Insurance', 'HSA', 'FSA', 'Pension', '401(k)', '403(b)'. The 'Rate' column lists '10%', '15%', '20%', '25%', '30%', '35%', '40%', '45%', '50%', '55%', '60%', '65%'. The 12 months of data are listed in columns labeled 'Month 1' through 'Month 12'. Below the table, there is a summary section with labels 'Total Health Insurance', 'Total Dental Insurance', 'Total Life Insurance', 'Total Disability Insurance', 'Total Retirement', 'Total Medical Insurance', 'Total Vision Insurance', 'Total HSA', 'Total FSA', 'Total Pension', 'Total 401(k)', 'Total 403(b)'. The summary section shows values for each category across the 12 months.

How do you predict changes to your staffing plan, like new hires or layoffs? It all goes back to your projected revenue and the people drivers associated with those projections.

Let's revisit our digital marketing agency, which is increasing the number of new clients each month. Currently, the agency has four employees, and each employee's capacity is nine new projects per month.

At the agency's predicted growth, there are enough employees to cover the first two months of work. By month three, the agency will need to hire a new employee, increasing the overall staffing and benefits cost moving forward.

Step 4: Operating Expenses

The Operating Expenses (OpEx) tab is already auto-populated with the information you entered in the Prep Sheet tab. Now, it's time to review these expenses and see if your expenses will increase or decrease based on your revenue and staffing projections.

You can manually update the month and expenses you think will change. The total monthly salaries, wages, and benefits cost that you calculated in the Workforce tab is at the top of the Fixed Expenses section.



	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December
Advertising	\$5,250	\$6,125	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000
Software License	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000
Salaries	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000
Office Supplies	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500
Utilities	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000
Travel	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500
Insurance & Legal	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000

As you may have guessed, your revenue and staffing goals impact the changes to your operating expenses.

Earlier, we said that our digital marketing agency is increasing its website visitors by 1,000 new visitors per month. They are doing that by running paid advertising to their website, which accounts for 50% of their new traffic. Their average cost per click is \$1.75.

Knowing this, we can project their advertising budget each month.

Month 1: $6,000 \times 0.50 = 3,000$; $3,000 \times \$1.75 = \$5,250$

Month 2: $7,000 \times 0.50 = 3,500$; $3,500 \times \$1.75 = \$6,125$

Month 3: $8,000 \times 0.50 = 4,000$; $4,000 \times \$1.75 = \$7,000$

	January	February	March	April	May	June	July	August	September	October	November	December
Advertising	\$5,250	\$6,125	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000	\$7,000
Software License	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000
Salaries	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000
Office Supplies	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500
Utilities	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000
Travel	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$500
Insurance & Legal	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$1,000

An example of an operating expense that would change due to staffing changes is the software license you purchase per employee. Our digital marketing agency pays \$50 per month for each employee's software license. When they hire a new employee in Month 3, their software cost will increase by \$50.

An example of an operating expense that would change due to staffing changes is the software license you purchase per employee. Our digital marketing agency pays \$50 per month for each employee's software license. When they hire a new employee in Month 3, their software cost will increase by \$50.

Step 5: Capital Expenses

In the Prep Sheet tab, you listed two types of capital expenses: expenses related to staffing and general capital expenses. Based on your Staffing Plan, you'll update the Capital Expenses (CapEx) tab with any staff-related expenses. Then, you'll update the tab with any general capital expenses.

Note: The information you entered in the Prep Sheet tab won't auto-populate to the Capital Expenses tab. You can use this as a reference, but you'll need to manually input the asset name and cost.

Worksheet: Revenue by Product Category												
Product Category	Sub-Category	Product Name	Unit Price	Quantity Sold	Total Revenue	Profit Margin	Market Share	Customer Satisfaction	Competitor Analysis	Marketing Spend	ROI	Notes
Electronics	Smartphones	iPhone 13	\$1,200	150	\$180,000	25%	15%	4.5	Apple	\$50,000	300%	High demand
Electronics	Smartphones	Samsung Galaxy S22	\$1,100	180	\$198,000	20%	18%	4.3	Samsung	\$45,000	250%	Strong competitor
Electronics	Smartphones	Google Pixel 6	\$1,000	120	\$120,000	30%	10%	4.6	Google	\$30,000	400%	Niche player
Electronics	Smartphones	OnePlus 9 Pro	\$900	100	\$90,000	28%	8%	4.4	OnePlus	\$25,000	350%	Mid-range leader
Electronics	Smartphones	Xiaomi Mi 11	\$800	200	\$160,000	15%	20%	4.2	Xiaomi	\$40,000	200%	Value for money
Electronics	Smartphones	Huawei P50 Pocket	\$1,500	80	\$120,000	35%	5%	4.7	Huawei	\$35,000	500%	Foldable innovation
Electronics	Smartphones	Motorola Edge 2022	\$700	140	\$98,000	22%	7%	4.1	Motorola	\$20,000	300%	Design focus
Electronics	Smartphones	Nokia 8.3	\$600	110	\$66,000	18%	3%	4.0	Nokia	\$15,000	250%	Reliability
Electronics	Smartphones	BlackBerry KEY2	\$500	90	\$45,000	10%	1%	3.8	BlackBerry	\$10,000	150%	Enterprise focus
Electronics	Smartphones	ASUS ROG Phone 5	\$1,300	70	\$91,000	32%	6%	4.4	ASUS	\$22,000	450%	Gaming phone
Electronics	Smartphones	Nothing Phone 1	\$700	130	\$91,000	20%	4%	4.2	Nothing	\$18,000	280%	Minimalist design
Electronics	Smartphones	Realme GT 5 Pro	\$850	160	\$136,000	12%	12%	4.1	Realme	\$32,000	180%	Performance
Electronics	Smartphones	Oppo Find N	\$1,800	60	\$108,000	38%	4%	4.6	Oppo	\$28,000	550%	Ultra-thin foldable
Electronics	Smartphones	Vivo X Fold	\$1,600	50	\$80,000	30%	3%	4.5	Vivo	\$20,000	400%	Large display
Electronics	Smartphones	Honor Magic V2	\$1,400	40	\$56,000	25%	2%	4.3	Honor	\$15,000	350%	Compact foldable
Electronics	Smartphones	Motorola Razr 2022	\$1,000	30	\$30,000	15%	1%	4.0	Motorola	\$8,000	200%	Flip phone revival
Electronics	Smartphones	ASUS ZenFold 2	\$1,200	20	\$24,000	20%	0.5%	4.1	ASUS	\$5,000	250%	Productivity focus
Electronics	Smartphones	Nothing Phone 2	\$750	150	\$112,500	22%	5%	4.3	Nothing	\$19,000	300%	Software updates
Electronics	Smartphones	Realme GT Neo5	\$900	170	\$153,000	10%	10%	4.2	Realme	\$30,000	160%	Performance & price
Electronics	Smartphones	Oppo Find X6	\$1,100	140	\$154,000	18%	8%	4.4	Oppo	\$25,000	280%	Camera quality
Electronics	Smartphones	Vivo X90 Pro	\$1,300	120	\$156,000	20%	7%	4.5	Vivo	\$22,000	320%	Camera & performance
Electronics	Smartphones	Honor Magic5	\$1,000	100	\$100,000	15%	6%	4.3	Honor	\$18,000	220%	Design & performance
Electronics	Smartphones	Motorola Edge 40	\$800	130	\$104,000	18%	5%	4.2	Motorola	\$17,000	260%	Design & performance
Electronics	Smartphones	Nokia 9.3	\$700	110	\$77,000	12%	2%	4.1	Nokia	\$16,000	210%	Reliability & design
Electronics	Smartphones	BlackBerry KEY3	\$600	90	\$54,000	8%	0.5%	3.9	BlackBerry	\$12,000	140%	Enterprise & design
Electronics	Smartphones	ASUS ROG Phone 6	\$1,400	80	\$112,000	30%	7%	4.5	ASUS	\$24,000	480%	Gaming & performance
Electronics	Smartphones	Nothing Phone 2 Pro	\$850	140	\$119,000	25%	6%	4.4	Nothing	\$20,000	320%	Software & design
Electronics	Smartphones	Realme GT Neo6	\$950	160	\$152,000	10%	11%	4.3	Realme	\$31,000	170%	Performance & price
Electronics	Smartphones	Oppo Find X7	\$1,200	150	\$180,000	18%	9%	4.5	Oppo	\$26,000	290%	Camera & performance
Electronics	Smartphones	Vivo X100 Pro	\$1,400	130	\$182,000	20%	8%	4.6	Vivo	\$23,000	330%	Camera & performance
Electronics	Smartphones	Honor Magic6	\$1,100	110	\$121,000	15%	7%	4.4	Honor	\$19,000	230%	Design & performance

Once again, your revenue plan and planned growth can impact your capital expenses. Let's go back to our restaurant that's converting their dine-in customers to take out.

They may discover that one way to convert more customers to take out is by offering a delivery service. The restaurant decides to invest in a vehicle that they'll use for delivery, which will also save them money on expensive delivery service commission fees. This is a general capital expense.

An example of a staffing-related capital expense is purchasing a new laptop for each new hire. If we go back to our favorite digital marketing agency, we know that in Month 3, they'll hire a new employee. Each employee's laptop costs \$1,500. In Month 3, they'll have \$1,500 in capital expenses.

Note: To keep things from getting too complicated, this spreadsheet model doesn't take into account depreciation or amortization expense—just the initial outlay for the capital purchases. If you're interested in a model that automatically calculates the accrual basis impact of capital purchases, consider [Jirav's financial modeling software](#).

Reviewing the numbers

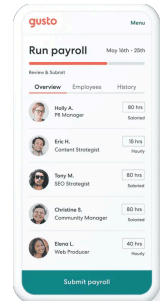
ur forecast is complete! That wasn't too bad, was it?

Now it's time to review the numbers and the results of your forecast. In our next article, we'll go in-depth about analyzing these results and making financial decisions based on your projections. For now, let's do a basic overview of the Profit and Loss (aka income statement), Balance Sheet, and Cash Flow tabs.



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Profit and Loss

This tab summarizes the information from the Revenue & COGS and Operating Expenses tabs.

A blurred screenshot of a Profit and Loss statement table. The table has multiple columns representing different time periods (likely months) and rows representing various financial metrics. The top row is highlighted in orange, and the bottom row is highlighted in green. The table is presented in a landscape orientation.

Here's you'll see your monthly:

- Gross revenue: The total revenue you earn each month.
- Cost of goods sold (COGS): The total you spend on COGS each month.
- Net revenue: Gross revenue minus your COGS. This is how much you earn after you cover the direct cost of selling your products or services.
- Fixed expenses: Your total fixed expenses, including compensation and benefits.
- Variable expenses: Your total variable expenses.
- Net income: Your net revenue minus your fixed and variable expenses.

All of these numbers have an essential role to play in your overall business model. But today we're just focusing on the Net income (Loss) line and seeing if the number is positive or negative.

A positive net income means that your business is earning more than it spends on COGS and operating expenses. In other words, you have a profit! A negative number means that your business is spending more than it makes, and you have a loss.

Balance Sheet

The Balance Sheet tab shows your month-to-month financial position. From here, you can see a snapshot of your assets (what you have), liabilities (what you owe), and equity (your assets minus your liabilities).



	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Assets												
Cash	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000
Accounts Receivable (A/R)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
A/R Increase or Decrease	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Fixed Assets	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other Assets	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Liabilities												
Accounts Payable (A/P)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Notes Payable	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other Liabilities	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Equity												
Equity	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000	1000

Assets include your cash on hand, accounts receivable, and fixed assets. Let's break these down a little further:

- **Cash:** This is based on the cash balance you entered in the Prep Sheet tab and then takes into account your projected monthly receivables and payables, fixed assets purchases (aka your capital expenses), your liability payments, and your profit (or loss) from that month.
- **Accounts Receivable (A/R):** This is what your customers owe. If you click on the + button on the left, you'll see your A/R broken down into three types of terms—30 days, 60 days, and 90 days. Based on the information in the Prep Sheet tab, this line will calculate your projected receivables every month.
- **A/R Increase or Decrease:** You must click on the + button next to row 10 to see this line. You'll notice that each month your A/R balances change. That's because each month, a portion of these balances is being incurred and paid. This line simply shows you the change month to month.
- **Fixed Assets:** This line is based on the starting value of your fixed assets from your Prep Sheet tab, plus any capital expenses that you purchased that month. If you click on the + button, you'll see the lines Increase and Decrease. The Increase line pulls from the Capital Expenses tab. If you sell assets, you can manually enter the value of the asset you sold, and this will decrease the overall value of your fixed assets.
- **Other Assets:** Here, you can manually enter additional fixed assets that you purchase.
- **Total Assets:** On this line, you'll see all of the assets you'll have each month based on your projections.



	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3	Month 4	Month 5	Month 6	Month 7	Month 8	Month 9	Month 10	Month 11	Month 12	Total
Accounts Payable													
Accounts	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$120,000
A/P Increase	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$60,000
A/P Decrease	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$60,000
Total	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$180,000
Notes Payable													
Notes	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$300,000
Increase	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$25,000	\$300,000
Decrease													
Other Liabilities													
Other	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$120,000
Increase	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$120,000
Decrease													
Total Liabilities	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$50,000	\$600,000

Liabilities include your current accounts payable and cash outflows like loan payments.

- **Accounts Payable (A/P):** These are the payments that you owe your vendors. Like the accounts receivable line, if you click on the + button, you'll see more details about your A/P broken out by your terms and the balance of what's due.
- **A/P Increase or Decrease:** As you pay off your vendor bills, the balance of your A/P account will change. This line shows you the change to your A/P account balance month to month.
- **Notes Payable:** These are your monthly loan payments. The starting balance is based on what you entered on the Prep Sheet tab. If you click on the + button, you can manually enter increases and decreases to your total Notes Payable.

An increase is debt that you plan to take on. So, if you take out a \$25,000 loan, you'll put the total loan disbursement amount in the month that you receive the loan. If your loan disbursement is split, enter the disbursement amounts for each month.

A decrease is a payment towards your debt. If you make monthly loan payments, enter the amount of the loan repayment that goes towards the principal. Another example of a decrease is having your Paycheck Protection Program (PPP) loan [fully or partially forgiven](#). You would enter the forgiveness amount here.



Current Month			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Assets													
Cash			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Accounts Receivable			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Inventory			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Prepaid Expenses			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Property, Plant, & Equipment			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Assets			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Liabilities													
Accounts Payable			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Long-Term Debt			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Liabilities			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Equity													
Owner's Equity			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Retained Earnings			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Equity			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Liabilities & Equity			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00

Equity shows you how much money you would receive if you liquidated all your assets and paid off all your debts. It's what would be left over for you, the owner. Sometimes people call this the net worth of their business.

- **Owner's Equity:** The starting balance is based on your total assets minus your liabilities. If you plan to add more equity to your business (for example, you choose to invest your own money into your business), click the + and enter the amount you'll invest on the Contributions line. If you plan to take money out of your business, like through an owner's draw or distribution, enter the amount you'll take out on the Distribution line.
- **Retained Earnings:** This is the profit that is retained in the business. In other words, the profit that you leave in the business and don't take out. These earnings can be retained for future investments in the business.
- **Total Equity:** This is the total equity that you, the owner, have in the company.

Current Month			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Assets													
Cash			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Accounts Receivable			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Inventory			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Prepaid Expenses			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Property, Plant, & Equipment			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Assets			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Liabilities													
Accounts Payable			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Long-Term Debt			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Liabilities			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Equity													
Owner's Equity			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Retained Earnings			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Equity			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00
Total Liabilities & Equity			\$0.00	\$1.00	\$2.00	\$3.00	\$4.00	\$5.00	\$6.00	\$7.00	\$8.00	\$9.00	\$10.00

Next, we have the Liabilities & Equity line, which, you may notice, matches the total on the Total Assets line. In the accounting world, this is how a balance sheet lives up to its namesake by balancing out.

The very last line of the Balance Sheet tab is called Check. This line ensures that the Balance Sheet does balance out. This line should always be zero. If it's not, there's an error on the Balance Sheet.

Cash Flow

The Cash Flow tab shows you if you have enough cash on hand to cover your bills, inventory or manufacturing costs, payroll, and debts, plus what's left after that monthly outflow.

The numbers here will likely be very different from your net income. That's because your cash flow takes into account other financing activities, like receiving loans or putting your own money into the business. It also accounts for other types of outflow in your business, like liability payments.



The screenshot displays a spreadsheet titled 'Cash Flow' with a grid of data. The columns represent months from January to December. The rows are categorized into four main sections: Operating Activities, Investing Activities, Financing Activities, and a final row for the Increase (Decrease) of Cash. Each section contains multiple sub-rows for specific financial items, with numerical values entered for each month. The Operating Activities section shows revenue and various expenses. Investing Activities include capital expenditures. Financing Activities show loan proceeds and payments. The final row summarizes the net change in cash for each month.

There are four sections of the Cash Flow tab.

- **Operating Activities:** This section accounts for all the inflow and outflow of cash from your revenue, operating expenses, accounts receivables, and accounts payable. Net cash from operating activities is the total cash left after you take into account all of these activities.
- **Investing Activities:** Remember those capital expenses you purchased? Here's where you'll see the cash out for those.
- **Financing Activities:** If you put your own money in your business or take out a loan, those activities will be reflected here. In the next article, we'll talk more about how to use the Cash Flow tab to predict how long a loan will last or when you need to take out a loan.
- **Increase (Decrease) of Cash:** For each month, you can see if you have positive or negative cash flow. Positive cash flow means that more cash has come into your business than has gone out. Remember, cash doesn't mean revenue. Cash can also come from financing activities. Negative cash flow means that more cash has gone out of your business than has come in.



- **Cash at the beginning and end of the period:** These lines show you how much projected cash you'll have in the bank at the end of each month. [Cash is a type of working capital](#) to cover your operations on a daily basis. If the number is negative, that means that you wouldn't have enough cash that month to cover all of your activities.

You just finished your first cash flow forecast! At this point, you likely already have a lot of useful information and ideas about what's next for your business.

[In the next article, we'll show you how to use the information in this forecast to make cash flow projections](#) about your business and plan proactively for your future. The template (a Google Sheet that could also be downloaded in Excel) includes a [worksheet with a cash flow projection template](#).

FAQs

Why do you need a cash flow forecast?

Creating regular cash flow forecasts is a crucial part of good financial management in your business. A cash flow forecast predicts your incoming cash over a specific period, so you know how much working capital you have on hand to cover short-term expenses and investments. In general, financial forecasts give you insight into your business's financial health, improving your budgeting and strategic decision-making.

How far ahead should a cash flow projection be forecasted?

How far ahead you should project your cash flow depends on what you're using the forecast for. For daily cash management or more insight into your monthly cash flow, forecasting a few weeks out works great. For payroll management and short-term planning (or demonstrating cash flow stability to lenders), a three-month forecast is best. For strategic company growth and risk management, 12-month forecasts are best.

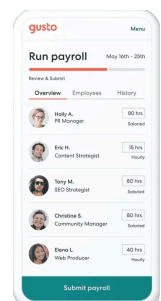
How often should a cash flow projection be updated?

You should update your cash flow projection once a month and any time a significant event happens, such as if you experience a sudden boost in sales, a payment is delayed, or your business needs change.



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How do businesses account for seasonal fluctuations in a cash flow projection?

Accounting for seasonal fluctuations in a cash flow projection comes down to historical data. You need to have at least a full year of sales data to better map out the ups and downs in a given season.

What common mistakes should be avoided when creating cash flow projections?

When you're creating cash flow projections, the most important thing to do is base your forecasts on actual data. Most cash flow forecast mistakes come back to ignoring or misinterpreting sales figures and metrics. For the most accurate prediction of cash flow, you need to use accurate historical sales and cash flow data.

[In the next article, we'll show you how to use the information in this forecast to make cash flow projections](#) about your business and plan proactively for your future. The template (a Google Sheet that could also be downloaded in Excel) includes a [worksheet with a cash flow projection template](#).

Business Finance

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[Andi Smiles](#) | Small business financial consultant

Andi is a small business financial consultant and coach who teaches business owners to take control of their finances. She's helped hundreds of self-employed folx organize and understand their business finances, while also uncovering their emotional relationship with money.

Quick note: This is not to be taken as tax advice. Since tax rules change over time and can vary by location and industry, consult a CPA or tax advisor for specific guidance. [Find an accountant](#)

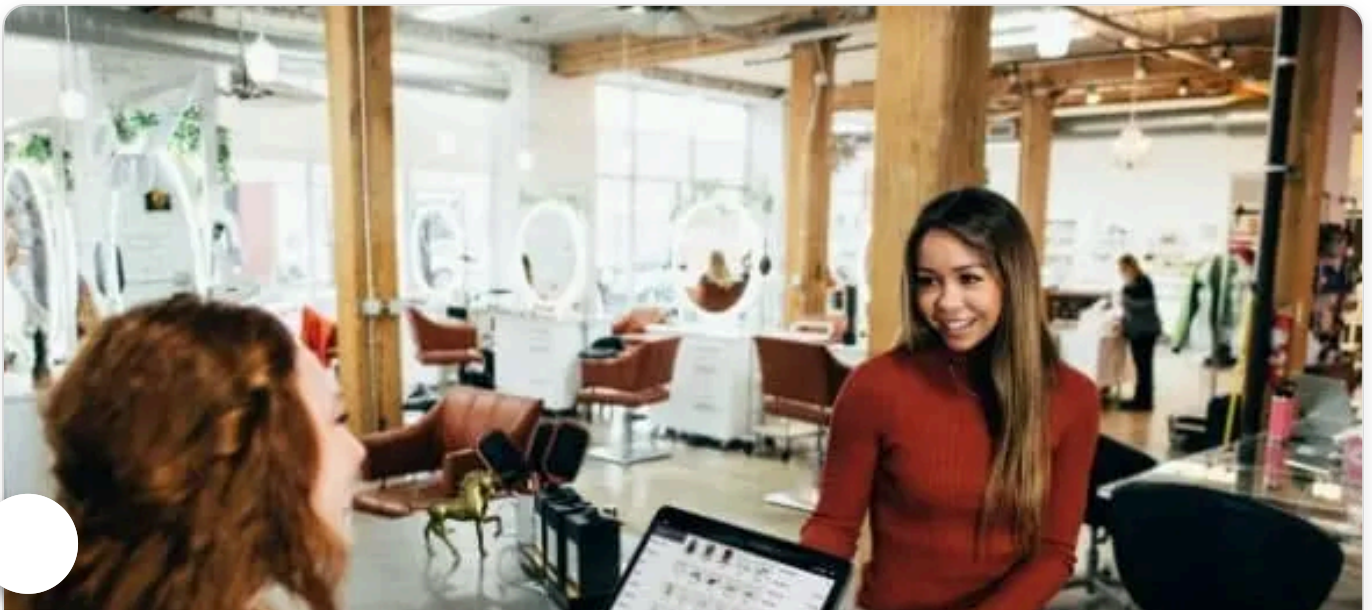


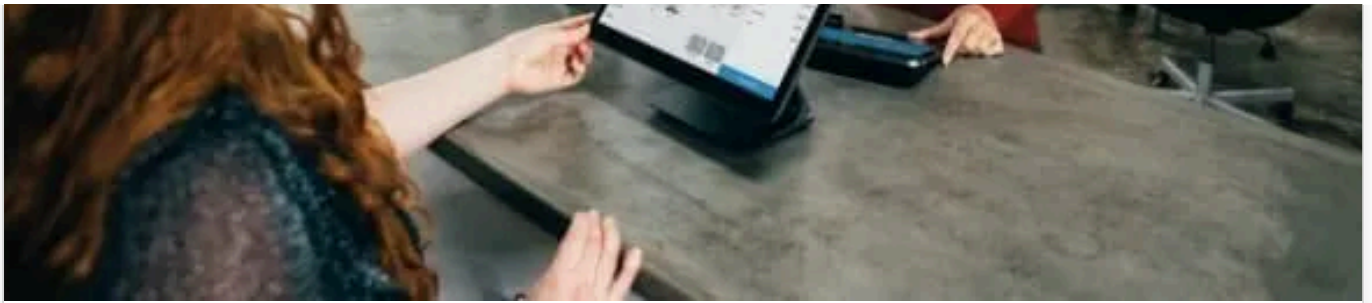
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